LifeOS Design Style Guide

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Design direction

One line. A calm, deep-night interface that feels alive: the current dark violet look, with more depth, light and motion, so that checking your day feels rewarding instead of like admin.

Kept from today. From your notification screenshot: the near-black navy background, violet as the one accent color, rounded cards with thin borders, small tinted icon tiles (gold for achievements, blue for time), lavender links, and a clean sans-serif. These stay, because they already feel focused and modern.

Improved

- **Depth.** Layered surfaces with soft glass, light borders and a gentle violet glow, so cards feel raised and important things feel lit.
- **Hierarchy.** One clear action per screen, bigger numbers for what matters (streaks, progress, time), quieter chrome around them.
- **Life.** Purposeful motion on every state change: progress fills, check-ins complete with a small flourish, blocks slide into place.
- **Order at scale.** 21 domains grouped into 5 color families, so the app stays readable instead of turning into a rainbow.
- **Calm.** Fewer, grouped notifications and clearer "needs your answer" states.

Note on the values below. Colors are read by eye from your screenshot and are starting values. Replace them with the exact values from your stylesheet and keep the rules.

Design principles

1. **Calm first, delight second.** The base is quiet. Color and motion appear only where they mean something: progress, completion, a change that needs you.
2. **One thing matters per screen.** Each screen has one primary action in the accent color, and everything else steps back.
3. **Show progress, not pressure.** Rings, streaks and counts celebrate what was done. A miss is shown neutrally, never in red, and always with a gentle next step.
4. **Motion explains.** Animation shows where something came from and where it went (a block sliding into the calendar, a task folding into its parent), never decoration for its own sake.

5. **Thumb first.** Everything important is reachable one-handed, with large targets and primary actions in the lower half of the screen.

Color system

Violet stays the only accent, and five hue families keep the 21 domains readable. The values are starting points taken by eye from your screenshot.



palette · 17 colors in 4 groups

Rules

- **Surfaces** step up in lightness (base, surface, raised) so depth comes from layers, not heavy shadows.
- **Violet** is for the one primary action per screen, the active tab and focus rings. The light violet is for links and highlights, and the glow is for soft halos behind key moments.
- **Clusters.** Each of the 5 clusters owns one hue. A domain takes its cluster's hue shifted by up to 8 degrees and varied in lightness by up to 6 percent, so the 7 domains in Study and work are related but still tell apart on the calendar.
- **Meaning colors** keep their meaning everywhere: green for done, amber for needs attention, red only for real errors and destructive actions, blue for information.

- **Misses are neutral.** A missed commitment uses the muted text color with a soft outline, never red.
- **Gold** (an achievement tone close to the amber) is reserved for achievements and streak milestones, always paired with an icon.
- **Tint on surfaces.** Icon tiles and chips use the hue at about 15% opacity on the surface, with the full hue for the icon, as in your current notification cards.
- **Contrast.** Body text must reach at least 4.5 to 1 against its surface, and large text and icons at least 3 to 1. Check every new color pair before it ships.
- **Light theme.** Optional and later: invert the surface steps and darken the hues; do not lighten the dark theme's tints.

Typography

Keep a clean geometric sans like the one you use now (Inter or a close match), and make the numbers the stars.

Style	Size / line height	Weight	Use
Display number	40 / 44	700	Streak, adherence ring center, hours
Title	24 / 30	650	Screen titles
Section	18 / 24	600	Card and section headings
Body	16 / 24	400	Main text, chat
Secondary	14 / 20	400	Descriptions, timestamps
Caption	12 / 16	500	Chips, labels, tab names

Rules

- Use tabular (fixed-width) numbers for times, counts and progress so they do not jump while counting up.
- Never go below 12px, and keep body text at 16px on phones.
- Two weights per screen are enough: regular for reading, semibold for what to act on.
- Sentence case everywhere; no all-caps except tiny captions with extra letter spacing.
- Limit lines to about 40 to 50 characters on phones for notification and card text, and let long titles wrap to two lines instead of cutting them off.

Space, shape and depth

Token	Value	Use
Spacing scale	4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48 px	All padding and gaps; screen edge padding is 16
Radius	12 for chips and inputs, 20 for cards, 28 for sheets, full for pills and rings	Matches your current rounded cards
Border	1px at 8% white	Every card edge; gives the glass look
Glass	Surface at 70% opacity with a 16px background blur	Sheets, the bottom bar, the chat composer
Glow	Violet at 25% opacity, 24px blur	Behind the primary button, active tab and key status card
Gradient wash	Top-left violet at 12% fading to the surface	Hero cards such as the "Phone Alerts Active" card
Shadow	Soft, dark, offset down 8px, 24px blur	Floating items only: sheets, menus, toasts

Depth rules

- Three layers only: background, cards, and floating elements. Do not stack more.
- Cards separate by a surface step and a thin border, not by dark shadows, which disappear on a dark background.
- Use glow sparingly: at most one glowing element per screen, so it still means "look here".
- Add a faint grain or noise texture (2 to 3% opacity) to the background if it looks flat; skip it if it costs performance.

Motion and animation

Motion is what makes the app feel lively and premium, so it follows a few strict rules.

- **Fast and soft.** Most animations last 150 to 400 ms. Appearing things use ease-out, leaving things use ease-in, and things you move with your finger use a gentle spring.
- **Meaningful.** Each animation shows cause and effect: where something came from and where it went.
- **Cheap.** Animate only position, scale and opacity, so it stays smooth on a mid-range phone.

- **One flourish per screen.** A celebration happens once at a real milestone, not on every tap.
- **Respectful.** If the phone has reduce motion turned on, swap movement for a quick fade.

Moment	Animation	Time
Screen opens	Cards fade in and rise 12 px, staggered 40 ms apart	280 ms
Domain card to domain page	Card expands into the page header (shared element)	320 ms
Any tap	Press scales to 97% and springs back	100 ms
Check-in: Achieved	Button fills violet, the check draws itself, a soft glow ring pulses once, the card collapses to a one-line "Achieved" with Undo	300 ms, then 250 ms
Check-in: Missed	Card fades to the muted style and collapses; no shake, no red	250 ms
Task completed	Strike line draws across, the row slides away, the parent's ring advances	200 ms and 250 ms
Progress ring and numbers	Ring fills from the old value and the number counts up	700 ms
Streak milestone	Gold sparkle burst around the number, once	800 ms
Block added by the agent	Block slides from the chat card into its calendar slot	350 ms
Suggested (dashed) block	Dashed border breathes very softly until accepted	2.4 s loop
Drag on the calendar	Block lifts (scale 103% and shadow), snaps into the slot with a spring	200 ms
Loading	Skeleton shimmer; for the agent, three pulsing dots plus short status text such as "Checking conflicts"	1.4 s loop
Undo toast	Slides up from the bottom and stays about 5 seconds	250 ms

Moment	Animation	Time
Notification swipe	Card follows the finger and springs away; remaining cards close the gap	250 ms

Components

Component	Design
Primary button	Violet fill, 52 px tall, 20 px radius, soft glow, white text; one per screen, placed in the lower half
Secondary button	Transparent with a 1 px border and light text; same height
Card	Surface fill, 20 px radius, 1 px border at 8% white, 16 px padding; hero cards get the gradient wash
Icon tile	40 px rounded square tinted with the item's hue at 15%, full-hue icon
Chip	32 px tall pill; selected chips fill with the hue at 20% and show the hue as a border
Notification card	Grouped under "Needs your answer", "Upcoming" and "Earlier"; unanswered check-ins show Achieved and Missed side by side; answered ones collapse to one line with Undo; swipe to dismiss
Quick-add sheet	Glass bottom sheet with title field, date chips, estimate chips and an "Add subtasks" row; the Save button sits above the keyboard
Progress ring	8 px stroke in the domain hue on a 10% track; the number sits in the center in the display style
Task row	56 px tall, checkbox on the left, subtask checklist indented below, a thin progress bar under the parent
Calendar block	Tinted fill at 20% with a 3 px left bar in the domain hue; suggested blocks use a dashed border; tier 1 anchors show a small lock icon
Inputs	52 px, 12 px radius, label above, violet focus ring, clear inline errors

Component	Design
Toast	Glass pill with the message and an Undo action
Bottom navigation	Glass bar with five items (Today, Calendar, Chat, Domains, Review); the active item shows a violet pill and a small glow; Settings and Diary sit behind the profile and a Today shortcut
Empty state	A small line illustration in the cluster hue, one sentence and one action button

Screen-by-screen upgrades

Screen	Upgrade
Today	A greeting header with the day's one-line focus; a hero card for "Now" or "Next" with a countdown ring; next 3 tasks as clean rows; the evening check-in card slides up after 6 PM; a faint sky-like gradient that shifts from morning to night
Calendar	Layer chips grouped by cluster with a "show only" tap; blocks with a left color bar; a glowing "now" line; smooth month, week and day zoom transitions; suggested blocks dashed with an "Accept all" floating pill
Chat	Message bubbles on glass; the agent's change shows as a compact card (what, when, domain color) with Undo; the working state shows live steps; quick-reply chips for confirmations
Domains	Five cluster sections with a color-tinted header, a 2-column card grid with a small progress ring per card, search at the top and pinned favorites as a horizontal row
Notifications	Header with a count; "Needs your answer" group first; one-line answered states; "Mark all as read" affects only read state; the status card stays at the top but collapses after the first view

Screen	Upgrade
Reset Plan	A journey view of the 90 days with phase nodes and review diamonds; day counter as a display number; the adherence ring as the hero; reports open as a calm story-style scroll
Habit Tracker	A weekly dot grid per habit, streak numbers with grace days shown as softer dots, goal tracks as progress bars with a pace marker
Diary	A writing-first screen: a large quiet text area, a soft background, a small mood and energy tap row, and nothing else; a lock icon shows it is private
Weekly review	Step-by-step cards (done, slipped, balance wheel, priorities, next week) with a progress bar at the top and a single Accept at the end
Settings	Grouped lists with icons, search, plain-language descriptions under each switch, and sensitive-domain switches in their own "Private" group

Premium details

Small touches are what make an app feel expensive.

- **Icons.** One line-icon set (for example Lucide) at a 1.75 px stroke and 24 px size, rounded ends, used everywhere. No mixing of filled and outlined styles except for the active tab.
- **Haptics.** A light tap on toggles and check-ins, a soft success pattern on Achieved, nothing on errors except a short double tap. Haptics and sound can be switched off in Settings; sound is off by default.
- **Voice and copy.** Warm, short and plain. "Nice, that's done" instead of "Task completed successfully". Misses read "No worries, want to move it to tomorrow?" Never shame, never exclamation marks in a row.
- **Empty states.** Each domain has a small illustration in its hue and a single clear next step, so a new, empty domain looks inviting, not broken.
- **Time of day.** The background gradient shifts subtly with morning, day, evening and night, and the greeting follows.
- **Celebrations.** Reserved for real milestones: a 7-day streak, a finished phase, a completed exam plan. A gold sparkle, a short line of text, and no popups that block the screen.

- **Skeletons over spinners.** Show the layout of what is loading instead of a spinner, so the screen feels already there.
- **Details of craft.** Pixel-aligned icons, consistent corner radii, optical alignment of numbers inside rings, and smooth 60 frames per second scrolling.

Accessibility and performance

A premium app works for everyone and stays fast, so these rules apply to every screen.

Accessibility

- Text contrast of at least 4.5 to 1, and 3 to 1 for large text, icons and borders that carry meaning.
- Never use color alone: status always has an icon or a word too (done, needs answer, missed).
- Touch targets of at least 44 px with 8 px between them, and primary actions reachable by thumb.
- Screen reader labels on every icon button, ring and chart, with the value read out ("Adherence 72 percent").
- Reduce motion respected, text that scales with the phone's font size, and a visible focus ring for keyboards.

Performance of the design

- Animate only transform and opacity; avoid animating layout, blur radius or shadows.
- Limit background blur to the bottom bar, sheets and the composer, because blur is costly on older phones.
- Keep one running loop animation per screen at most, and pause loops when the screen is hidden.
- Use skeletons and optimistic updates, so screens respond at once while data saves.
- Test on a mid-range phone, not only a new one; if a flourish drops below 60 frames per second, shorten or remove it.

Implementation

The app already uses Next.js and Tailwind, so the style lives in design tokens (CSS variables) that Tailwind reads. Change a token once and every screen follows.

```
:root {
  --bg: #0B0A1A;
  --surface: #14122E;
  --raised: #1C1A3D;
```

```
  --text: #F4F3FF;
  --text-muted: #A9A6C9;
  --accent: #7C3AED;
  --accent-light: #A78BFA;
  --glow: rgba(124, 58, 237, 0.25);
  --border: rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.08);
  --radius-chip: 12px;
  --radius-card: 20px;
  --radius-sheet: 28px;
  --ease-out: cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1);
  --dur-fast: 150ms;
  --dur-base: 280ms;
}
@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) {
  :root { --dur-fast: 1ms; --dur-base: 1ms; }
}
```

Tools

- **Tailwind** with these tokens mapped in its theme.
- **shadcn/ui** for accessible base components (sheet, dialog, menu), restyled with the tokens.
- **Motion (Framer Motion)** for shared-element transitions, springs and swipe gestures; plain CSS for simple fades and the ring fill.
- **Lucide** for icons.
- **Storybook** to see every component in every state, and to check contrast and reduced motion.

Rollout

Step	Work	Done check
1. Tokens and base	Add tokens, restyle button, card, chip, input, toast; set type scale	The same screen looks right with only token changes
2. Daily screens	Today hero card, notification redesign with grouping and one-line answered states, quick-add sheet	Check-in answers collapse with the animation; "Mark all as read" leaves answers alone
3. Calendar and domains	Cluster layer chips, block style, now line, Domains grid with rings	Any domain in 2 taps; calendar stays smooth with a busy month

Step	Work	Done check
4. Growth screens	Reset Plan journey, Habit Tracker grid, Diary writing screen, weekly review steps	Each screen matches the screen upgrades above
5. Polish and audit	Haptics, empty states, reduced motion, contrast audit, test on a mid-range phone	Contrast and 60 frames per second checks pass